

MAXIMAL FILTERS IN THE LATTICE OF CLOSED CONVEX SETS

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ABSTRACT. The closed convex subsets of $\mathbb{R}^n$ form a complete lattice under inclusion. We classify its maximal filters. Each is determined by an affine subspace A , a linear subspace W containing the direction space of A , and a vector space order on W in which the direction space of A is order-convex; the only constraint is that $W = 0$ when A is a point, in which case the filter is principal. In particular the classifying space is a finite disjoint union of bundles over flag manifolds: no continuous modulus records the rate at which a filter approaches the flat it hugs. The results of Sections 2 through 6, and all but one of the remarks, are formalized in Lean 4, as are Sections 9 and 10. See Appendix A.

1. STATEMENT

Let $V = \mathbb{R}^n$ with dual V^* , and let $\mathcal{C}(V)$ denote the set of closed convex subsets of V , partially ordered by inclusion. Meets are intersections, joins are closed convex hulls of unions, $\emptyset$ is the bottom element and V the top. A *filter* is a nonempty subset $F \subseteq \mathcal{C}(V)$ that is upward closed, closed under binary intersection, and does not contain $\emptyset$. Filters are ordered by inclusion; *maximal* means maximal among filters. Zorn's lemma applies, since the union of a chain of filters is a filter.

For an affine subspace $A \subseteq V$ write $\text{dir } A \subseteq V$ for its direction space.

Definition 1.1. A *vector space order* on a finite dimensional real vector space U is a total order $\prec$ on U such that $v \prec w$ implies $v + z \prec w + z$ for all $z \in U$ and $\lambda v \prec \lambda w$ for all $\lambda > 0$. A subspace $U' \subseteq U$ is *order-convex* if $0 \prec w \prec v$ and $v \in U'$ imply $w \in U'$.

Theorem 1.2. *There is a bijection between the maximal filters of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ and the triples $(A, W, \prec)$ in which*

- (1) $A \subseteq V$ is a nonempty affine subspace,
- (2) $W \subseteq V$ is a linear subspace with $\text{dir } A \subseteq W$,
- (3) $\prec$ is a vector space order on W in which $\text{dir } A$ is order-convex,

subject to the single constraint that $W = 0$ whenever $\dim A = 0$. The filters with $\dim A = 0$ are exactly the principal ones.

Under the bijection, $S := A + W$ is the least affine subspace belonging to the filter, A is the least affine subspace all of whose neighborhoods in S belong to it, the restriction of $\prec$ to $\text{dir } A$ records the escape to infinity along A , and the order induced on $W/\text{dir } A$ records the side from which S approaches A . Sections 2–5 prove the theorem in the equivalent dual form of Theorem 6.1; Section 6 derives the form above. Section 7 lists the strata for $n \leq 3$.

Two features of the statement deserve emphasis. First, the constraint in the last clause is not a normalization but a theorem (Proposition 2.7): a filter of germs at a point is contained in the principal filter there and omits the point itself, so it is never maximal. In dimension one this is

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why there are exactly two non-principal maximal filters rather than a family attached to each point. Second, the data are discrete apart from the choice of A , W and the flag: two filters that hug the same flat from the same side at different rates coincide. The mechanism is Lemma 2.2 together with the argument of Theorem 4.2: two distinct maximal filters must be separated by a hyperplane, and hyperplanes are linear.

Maximal filters in a lattice of closed sets carry a compact T_1 topology by the representation of Wallman [5], and a Hausdorff one when the lattice is a normal base in the sense of Frink [1]. The lattice $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ meets neither hypothesis: it is not distributive, and it is not closed under finite unions, so it is not a base for the closed sets of $\mathbb{R}^n$ in the sense those constructions require. Section 9 applies Wallman's construction to it anyway, and Theorem 9.4 measures what the missing normality costs.

In the language of abstract convexity, developed in van de Vel [4], a convexity is normal when two disjoint convex closed sets can be screened within it, and the compactification theory is carried by superextensions, whose points are maximal linked systems rather than maximal filters [2]. Van de Vel [3] proved that for $n > 1$ Euclidean convexity admits no compactification in the sense of a compact topological convex structure containing $\mathbb{R}^n$ as a dense convex subspace with a continuous hull operator. That theorem and Proposition 9.10 are independent, as Remark 9.12 records. The maximal filters of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ do not appear in that literature, and the question settled in [3] does not appear to have been taken up since.

2. FILTERS IN $\mathcal{C}(V)$

Lemma 2.1. *A filter F is maximal if and only if for every $C \in \mathcal{C}(V) \setminus F$ there is $D \in F$ with $C \cap D = \emptyset$.*

Proof. Given $C \notin F$, the collection $F^+ = \{X \in \mathcal{C}(V) : X \supseteq C \cap D \text{ for some } D \in F\}$ is upward closed and closed under binary intersection, and contains $F \cup \{C\}$ properly. It is a filter precisely when $C \cap D \neq \emptyset$ for all $D \in F$. So F is maximal if and only if no such C admits this, which is the stated condition. Conversely the condition forbids any proper extension, since a filter containing both C and D would contain $\emptyset$. $\square$

Lemma 2.2. *Let $C, D \subseteq V$ be nonempty disjoint convex sets. Then there are $u \in V^* \setminus \{0\}$ and $t \in \mathbb{R}$ with $u \leq t$ on C and $u \geq t$ on D .*

Proof. The set $C - D$ is convex and omits 0. A point omitted by a convex subset of V is weakly separated from it: if $0 \notin \overline{C - D}$ apply strict separation, and otherwise 0 lies on the boundary of $C - D$ and a supporting functional exists. Thus $u(c) \leq u(d)$ for all $c \in C$, $d \in D$ and some $u \neq 0$; take $t = \sup_C u$. $\square$

For $u \in V^*$ and $t \in \mathbb{R}$ write $[u \leq t] = \{x \in V : u(x) \leq t\}$ and similarly $[u \geq t]$, $[u = t]$.

Lemma 2.3 (Dichotomy). *Let F be maximal, $u \in V^*$, $t \in \mathbb{R}$. Then $[u \leq t] \in F$ or $[u \geq t] \in F$.*

Proof. If $[u \leq t] \notin F$, Lemma 2.1 supplies $D \in F$ disjoint from $[u \leq t]$, whence $D \subseteq [u \geq t]$. $\square$

Definition 2.4. For a maximal filter F and $u \in V^*$ set $\Sigma_F(u) = \{t \in \mathbb{R} : [u \leq t] \in F\}$ and

$$\sigma_F(u) = \inf \Sigma_F(u) \in [-\infty, +\infty],$$

with $\inf \emptyset = +\infty$. Set

$$Q_F = \{u \in V^* : \Sigma_F(u) \text{ is open and } \Sigma_F(u) \neq \mathbb{R}\}.$$

Since F is upward closed, $\Sigma_F(u)$ is an up-set in $\mathbb{R}$, hence one of $\emptyset$, $\mathbb{R}$, (σ, ∞) , $[\sigma, \infty)$. Thus $u \in Q_F$ if and only if either $\sigma_F(u) = +\infty$, or $\sigma_F(u) \in \mathbb{R}$ and $[u \leq \sigma_F(u)] \notin F$. Note $\sigma_F(0) = 0$ and $0 \notin Q_F$.

Proposition 2.5. *Let F be maximal and write $\sigma = \sigma_F$, $Q = Q_F$.*

- (1) $\sigma(u+v) \leq \sigma(u) + \sigma(v)$ whenever the right side is defined, and $\sigma(\lambda u) = \lambda \sigma(u)$ for $\lambda > 0$.
- (2) For each u exactly one of the following holds: $\sigma(u)$ and $\sigma(-u)$ are both finite and sum to 0; $\sigma(u) = +\infty$ and $\sigma(-u) = -\infty$; $\sigma(u) = -\infty$ and $\sigma(-u) = +\infty$.
- (3) $N := \{u : \sigma(u) \in \mathbb{R}\}$ is a linear subspace and $\sigma|_N$ is linear.
- (4) $M := V^* \setminus (Q \cup -Q)$ is a linear subspace contained in N , and Q is a convex cone with $Q \cap -Q = \emptyset$, $Q + M = Q$.

Proof. (1) If $[u \leq s], [v \leq t] \in F$ then $[u \leq s] \cap [v \leq t] \in F$ is contained in $[u+v \leq s+t]$. Homogeneity is the identity $[\lambda u \leq \lambda t] = [u \leq t]$.

(2) If $\sigma(u) = \sigma(-u) = -\infty$ then $[u \leq t]$ and $[u \geq s]$ lie in F for all $t < s$, contradicting properness. If $\sigma(u) = +\infty$ then $[u \leq t] \notin F$ for all t , so $[u \geq t] \in F$ for all t by Lemma 2.3, that is $\sigma(-u) = -\infty$; this rules out both values being $+\infty$. Suppose now both are finite, and put $a = \sigma(u)$, $b = \sigma(-u)$. For s, t with $[u \leq t], [u \geq -s] \in F$ properness forces $-s \leq t$, so $a + b \geq 0$. If $a + b > 0$ pick c with $-b < c < a$; then $[u \leq c] \notin F$ since $c < a$, and $[u \geq c] \notin F$ since $-c < b$, contradicting Lemma 2.3. Hence $a + b = 0$.

(3) By (2), $u \in N$ if and only if $\sigma(u)$ and $\sigma(-u)$ are both finite, and then $\sigma(-u) = -\sigma(u)$. Closure under positive scalars is homogeneity, and closure under $u \mapsto -u$ is the previous sentence. If $u, v \in N$ then $\sigma(u+v) \leq \sigma(u) + \sigma(v) < \infty$ and $\sigma(-u-v) \leq \sigma(-u) + \sigma(-v) < \infty$, so $u+v \in N$ by (2); the two inequalities read $\sigma(u+v) \leq \sigma(u) + \sigma(v)$ and $-\sigma(u+v) \leq -\sigma(u) - \sigma(v)$, hence equality.

(4) Write $E = \{u : \sigma(u) = +\infty\}$ and $D = \{u \in N \setminus \{0\} : [u \leq \sigma(u)] \notin F\}$, so that $Q = E \sqcup D$ by the remark preceding the proposition, and by (2) and Lemma 2.3,

$$V^* = E \sqcup (-E) \sqcup N, \quad N \setminus \{0\} = D \sqcup (-D) \sqcup (M \cap N \setminus \{0\}),$$

where $M \cap N = \{u \in N : [u = \sigma(u)] \in F\}$. Indeed for $u \in N$ Lemma 2.3 at $t = \sigma(u)$ shows that at least one of $[u \leq \sigma(u)], [u \geq \sigma(u)]$ lies in F , so at least one of $u, -u$ fails to lie in D ; and both fail exactly when both half-spaces, hence the hyperplane, lie in F . Consequently $M = \{u \in N : [u = \sigma(u)] \in F\}$ and $Q \cap -Q = \emptyset$.

M is a subspace: it is stable under scalars, and if $[u = \sigma(u)], [v = \sigma(v)] \in F$ then their intersection lies in F and is contained in $[u+v = \sigma(u) + \sigma(v)] = [u+v = \sigma(u+v)]$.

E is closed under addition: if $\sigma(u) = \sigma(v) = +\infty$ then $\sigma(-u) = \sigma(-v) = -\infty$, so $\sigma(-u-v) = -\infty$ by (1) and $u+v \in E$ by (2). Also $E + N \subseteq E$, since $\sigma(-u-w) \leq \sigma(-u) + \sigma(-w) = -\infty$ for $u \in E, w \in N$.

D is closed under addition: let $u, v \in D$, so $[u \geq \sigma(u)], [v \geq \sigma(v)] \in F$. If $[u+v \leq \sigma(u+v)]$ were in F , then the intersection of these three members of F lies in $[u = \sigma(u)]$, forcing $u \in M$, contradiction. Also $D + M \subseteq D$: for $u \in D$ and $w \in M$, if $[u+w \leq \sigma(u+w)] \in F$ then intersecting with $[w = \sigma(w)] \in F$ gives a member of F inside $[u \leq \sigma(u)]$, contradiction. Finally $D + E \subseteq E$ has been covered by $E + N \subseteq E$. Hence $Q = E \sqcup D$ is a convex cone and $Q + M = Q$. $\square$

By Proposition 2.5(3) the linear functional $\sigma|_N$ on N is the restriction of evaluation at some point $a \in V$, so

$$A_F := \{x \in V : u(x) = \sigma_F(u) \text{ for all } u \in N\} = a + N^\perp$$

is a nonempty affine subspace with $\text{dir } A_F = N^\perp$, and σ_F is recovered from A_F and Q_F : it equals $u \mapsto u(a)$ on $N = (\text{dir } A_F)^\perp$, is $+\infty$ on $Q \setminus N$ and $-\infty$ on $-Q \setminus N$.

Proposition 2.6. *Let F be maximal, $M = M_F$ as above and $W := M^\perp$. Then $S_F := A_F + W$ is the least affine subspace belonging to F , and $\text{dir } S_F = W$.*

Proof. Choosing a basis $u_1, \dots, u_k$ of M exhibits $\bigcap_{u \in M} [u = \sigma(u)]$ as a finite intersection of members of F , hence a member of F ; since $M \subseteq N$ this intersection equals $a + M^\perp = A_F + W$. If $T \in F$ is affine, write T as an intersection of hyperplanes $[u = t]$; each contains T so lies in F , whence $\sigma(u) \leq t$ and $\sigma(-u) \leq -t$, so $\sigma(u) = t$ and $u \in M$. Thus $T \supseteq S_F$. $\square$

Proposition 2.7. *If $\dim A_F = 0$ then F is the principal filter at the point A_F , and then $M_F = V^*$, $W = 0$. Conversely every principal filter is maximal.*

Proof. Let $A_F = \{p\}$, so $N = V^*$ and $\sigma(u) = u(p)$ for all u . If $\{p\} \notin F$, Lemma 2.1 gives $C \in F$ with $p \notin C$; since $\{p\}$ is compact and C closed convex, strict separation provides u and t with $u(p) < t$ and $u \geq t$ on C . Then $[u \geq t] \in F$, so $\sigma(u) \geq t > u(p) = \sigma(u)$, a contradiction. Hence $\{p\} \in F$ and F is the principal filter at p ; every hyperplane through p then lies in F , so $M = V^*$. For the converse, if $p \notin C$ then $\{p\} \in F_p$ meets C emptily, so Lemma 2.1 applies. $\square$

Proposition 2.8 (Restriction). *Let $S \subseteq V$ be an affine subspace. The assignments*

$$F \mapsto F|_S := \{C \in \mathcal{C}(S) : C \in F\}, \quad G \mapsto G^V := \{C \in \mathcal{C}(V) : C \cap S \in G\}$$

are mutually inverse bijections between the maximal filters of $\mathcal{C}(V)$ containing S and the maximal filters of $\mathcal{C}(S)$. Moreover $\sigma_F(u) = \sigma_{F|_S}(u|_S)$ and $u \in Q_F$ if and only if $u|_S \in Q_{F|_S}$, where $u|_S$ denotes the restriction of the affine function u to S .

Proof. If $S \in F$ then $C \in F$ if and only if $C \cap S \in F$, which gives $F = (F|_S)^V$ and the displayed compatibilities at once. $F|_S$ is a filter, and is maximal by Lemma 2.1: if $B \in \mathcal{C}(S) \setminus F$ then some $C \in F$ is disjoint from B , and $C \cap S \in F|_S$ is disjoint from B . Conversely, for maximal G on $\mathcal{C}(S)$ the collection G^V is a filter containing S ; if $C \notin G^V$ then $C \cap S \notin G$, so some $B \in G$ is disjoint from $C \cap S$, and since $B \subseteq S$ it is disjoint from C . Finally $(G^V)|_S = G$. $\square$

Here $\mathcal{C}(S)$ is understood via any affine isomorphism $S \cong \mathbb{R}^{\dim S}$; the invariants transport accordingly. Combining Propositions 2.6 and 2.8, every maximal filter is determined by a maximal filter on its support S_F whose own M invariant vanishes.

3. VECTOR SPACE ORDERS

Throughout this section U is a finite dimensional real vector space. A vector space order $\prec$ on U is determined by its positive cone $P = \{v : v \succ 0\}$, which is a convex cone with $U = P \sqcup \{0\} \sqcup (-P)$; conversely any such cone defines a vector space order. Call such a P a *lex cone*.

Lemma 3.1. *Let $P \subseteq U$ be a lex cone, $k = \dim U$. There is a basis $v_1, \dots, v_k$ of U with*

$$P = \left\{ \sum_i c_i v_i : c_j > 0 \text{ where } j = \max\{i : c_i \neq 0\} \right\}.$$

The subspaces $U_i = \text{span}(v_1, \dots, v_i)$ depend only on P , and are exactly the order-convex subspaces of U ; the orientation of U_i/U_{i-1} determined by v_i likewise depends only on P . Conversely a complete flag together with an orientation of each successive quotient determines a lex cone.

Proof. Since $P \cup (-P) = U$, the cone P spans U and so has nonempty interior; the same holds for $-P$, and as $P \cap (-P) = \emptyset$ the closure $\overline{P}$ misses the interior of $-P$, so $\overline{P} \neq U$. A closed convex cone other than U has a supporting functional: there is $\ell \neq 0$ with $\ell \geq 0$ on P . If $\ell(x) > 0$ and $x \notin P$ then $x \neq 0$ and $-x \in P$, contradicting $\ell(-x) \geq 0$; hence $\{\ell > 0\} \subseteq P$ and

$$P = \{\ell > 0\} \sqcup (P \cap \ker \ell),$$

where $P \cap \ker \ell$ is a lex cone in $\ker \ell$. Induction on k produces $v_1, \dots, v_{k-1}$ for $\ker \ell$ and then v_k with $\ell(v_k) > 0$ gives the displayed description.

For the uniqueness clauses, let $U' \subseteq U$ be an order-convex subspace, $U' \neq 0$, and let j be least with $\ell_j|_{U'} \neq 0$, where $\ell_1, \dots, \ell_k$ is the basis of U^* dual to $v_1, \dots, v_k$ read in reverse, so that $P = \{c : (\ell_k(c), \dots)$ has last nonzero coordinate positive $\}$; concretely take j least with $U' \not\subseteq U_{k-j}$. Order-convexity gives $U' \supseteq U_i$ for the corresponding i : choose $x \in U'$ with $\ell(x) > 0$ for the relevant leading functional ℓ ; for any y killed by the earlier functionals and μ large, $\mu x \pm y \succ 0$, so $-\mu x \prec y \prec \mu x$ with $\mu x \in U'$, whence $y \in U'$. Thus the order-convex subspaces are precisely the U_i , which are therefore intrinsic; the induced order on U_i/U_{i-1} is one-dimensional, hence an orientation, and it is intrinsic for the same reason. The converse construction is the displayed formula. $\square$

Definition 3.2. Let P be a lex cone on U with flag $U_0 \subset \dots \subset U_k$ as in Lemma 3.1. For $\ell \in U^* \setminus \{0\}$ let $i(\ell)$ be least with $\ell|_{U_i} \neq 0$; then ℓ kills $U_{i(\ell)-1}$ and so induces a nonzero functional on the oriented line $U_{i(\ell)}/U_{i(\ell)-1}$. Set

$$P^\vee = \{\ell \in U^* \setminus \{0\} : \text{the induced functional is positive}\}.$$

Lemma 3.3. $P^\vee$ is a lex cone on U^* , with flag $U_k^\perp \subset U_{k-1}^\perp \subset \dots \subset U_0^\perp$. The map $P \mapsto P^\vee$ is a bijection from lex cones on U to lex cones on U^* , and $U' \subseteq U$ is order-convex for P if and only if $(U')^\perp \subseteq U^*$ is order-convex for $P^\vee$. In the basis notation of Lemma 3.1, with $v^1, \dots, v^k$ dual to $v_1, \dots, v_k$,

$$P^\vee = \left\{ \sum_i a_i v^i : a_j > 0 \text{ where } j = \min\{i : a_i \neq 0\} \right\}.$$

Proof. For $\ell = \sum_i a_i v^i$ one has $\ell|_{U_i} = 0$ exactly when $a_1 = \dots = a_i = 0$, so $i(\ell) = \min\{i : a_i \neq 0\}$ and the induced functional on $U_{i(\ell)}/U_{i(\ell)-1}$ sends the positive generator $v_{i(\ell)}$ to $a_{i(\ell)}$. This gives the displayed formula, which is a lex cone by Lemma 3.1 applied to the basis $v^k, \dots, v^1$ of U^* , with associated flag $\text{span}(v^1, \dots, v^i) = U_i^\perp$ read in the stated order. Since a lex cone is equivalent to its flag with orientations, and annihilation is an order-reversing bijection between complete flags of U and of U^* matching U_i/U_{i-1} with the dual of $U_{i-1}^\perp/U_i^\perp$, the map $P \mapsto P^\vee$ is bijective and matches flag members with flag members. Order-convex subspaces are flag members on both sides by Lemma 3.1. $\square$

4. UNIQUENESS

Lemma 4.1 (Relative separation). *Let $T \subseteq V$ be a nonempty affine subspace and let $C, D \subseteq T$ be nonempty disjoint convex sets. Then there are $u \in V^*$ and $t \in \mathbb{R}$ with $u \leq t$ on C , $u \geq t$ on D , and u nonconstant on T .*

Proof. Let $W = \text{dir } T$ and choose a linear complement U , so $V = W \oplus U$. The sets $C + U$ and $D + U$ are convex and nonempty. They are disjoint: if $c + u_1 = d + u_2$ with $c \in C$, $d \in D$, $u_1, u_2 \in U$, then $c - d \in W \cap U = 0$, so $c = d \in C \cap D$. Lemma 2.2 gives $u \neq 0$ and t with $u \leq t$ on $C + U$ and $u \geq t$ on $D + U$. If $u(v) \neq 0$ for some $v \in U$ then u is unbounded above on $C + U$, which it is not; so u vanishes on U , and since $u \neq 0$ it does not vanish on W . Restricting the two inequalities to C and D finishes. $\square$

Theorem 4.2. *Two maximal filters F, F' on $\mathcal{C}(V)$ with $\sigma_F = \sigma_{F'}$ and $Q_F = Q_{F'}$ are equal.*

Proof. Write $\sigma = \sigma_F = \sigma_{F'}$, $Q = Q_F = Q_{F'}$ and $M = V^* \setminus (Q \cup -Q)$, so that $S := \bigcap_{u \in M} [u = \sigma(u)]$ is an affine subspace depending only on the shared invariants. By Proposition 2.6 applied to each filter, $S \in F$ and $S \in F'$.

Suppose $C \in F \setminus F'$. By Lemma 2.1 applied to F' there is $C' \in F'$ with $C \cap C' = \emptyset$. The sets $C \cap S$ and $C' \cap S$ are members of F and of F' respectively, hence nonempty; they are convex, disjoint, and contained in S . Lemma 4.1 gives $u \in V^*$ and $t \in \mathbb{R}$ with $C \cap S \subseteq [u \leq t]$, $C' \cap S \subseteq [u \geq t]$, and u nonconstant on S .

Then $[u \leq t] \in F$, so $\sigma(u) \leq t$; and $[u \geq t] \in F'$, so no $[u \leq s]$ with $s < t$ lies in F' , giving $\sigma(u) \geq t$. Hence $\sigma(u) = t$ is finite. Now $[u \leq \sigma(u)] \in F$ shows $u \notin Q$, and $[-u \leq \sigma(-u)] = [u \geq t] \in F'$ shows $-u \notin Q$. Therefore $u \in M$, so u is constant on S , contradicting the last clause of Lemma 4.1. So $F \subseteq F'$, and maximality of F forces $F = F'$. $\square$

Remark 4.3. The proof uses no induction on dimension and does not invoke Proposition 2.8. Passing to S before separating replaces the inductive descent: the only functionals that can separate two members of the same maximal filter's support are those constant on that support, and those are exactly the ones the invariants already record.

5. REALIZATION

Fix integers $1 \leq d \leq m \leq n$, a basis $f_1, \dots, f_n$ of V with dual basis $u^1, \dots, u^n$, and a point $a \in V$. Write $x_i = u^i(x - a)$. Put

$$A_0 = a + \text{span}(f_1, \dots, f_d), \quad W_0 = \text{span}(f_1, \dots, f_m), \quad M_0 = \text{span}(u^{m+1}, \dots, u^n),$$

$$N_0 = \text{span}(u^{d+1}, \dots, u^n), \quad Q_0 = \left\{ \sum_i a_i u^i : a_j > 0 \text{ where } j = \min\{i \leq m : a_i \neq 0\} \right\}.$$

Thus Q_0 is the set of functionals whose first nonvanishing coordinate among the first m is positive, and M_0 is the set of those with no nonvanishing coordinate among the first m .

For $K, M \geq 1$ and $0 < c \leq 1$ let $C(K, M, c)$ be the set of $x \in V$ satisfying

- (1) $x_j = 0$ ($m < j \leq n$),
- (2) $x_d \geq K$,
- (3) $x_i \geq Mx_{i+1} + M$ ($1 \leq i \leq d-1$),
- (4) $x_{d+1} \leq c$, $x_j \leq cx_{j-1}$ ($d+1 < j \leq m$),
- (5) $x_j x_d \geq 1$ ($d < j \leq m$).

Every constraint but (5) is a closed half-space or hyperplane. The constraint (5), taken together with (2), cuts out $\{(s, y) : s \geq K, sy \geq 1\}$ in the coordinates (x_d, x_j) , which is convex because $s \mapsto 1/s$ is convex on $[K, \infty)$. So $C(K, M, c)$ is closed and convex.

Lemma 5.1. *$C(K, M, c)$ is nonempty, and $C(K', M', c') \subseteq C(K, M, c)$ whenever $K \leq K'$, $M \leq M'$ and $c' \leq c$. In particular the sets $C(k, k, 1/k)$, $k \geq 1$, form a decreasing sequence.*

Proof. On $C(K, M, c)$ one has $x_d \geq K \geq 1$, hence $x_i \geq x_{i+1} > 0$ for $i < d$ by (3) and downward induction, and $x_j \geq 1/x_d > 0$ for $j > d$ by (5). For nonemptiness choose $T \geq K$ with $Tc^{m-d} \geq 1$ and set $x_d = T$, $x_i = Mx_{i+1} + M$ downward from $i = d-1$, $x_{d+j} = c^j$ for $1 \leq j \leq m-d$, and $x_j = 0$ for $j > m$. Monotonicity in the parameters uses the positivity just established: $M'x_{i+1} + M' \geq Mx_{i+1} + M$ needs $x_{i+1} \geq 0$, and $c'x_{j-1} \leq cx_{j-1}$ needs $x_{j-1} \geq 0$. Constraint (5) does not involve the parameters. $\square$

Lemma 5.2. *Let F be a maximal filter containing every $C(K, M, c)$. Then $\sigma_F(u) = u(a)$ for $u \in N_0$, $Q_F = Q_0$, $M_F = M_0$ and $A_F = A_0$.*

Proof. Write $u = \sum_i a_i u^i$, so that $u(x) = u(a) + \sum_{i \leq m} a_i x_i$ on any $C(K, M, c)$, by (1).

If $a_i = 0$ for all $i \leq m$, that is $u \in M_0$, then $C(K, M, c) \subseteq [u = u(a)]$, so the hyperplane lies in F and $u \in M_F$ with $\sigma_F(u) = u(a)$.

Otherwise let $k = \min\{i \leq m : a_i \neq 0\}$ and assume $a_k > 0$, the case $a_k < 0$ following by negation.

Suppose $k \leq d$. Fix t . If $k = d$ then $u(x) \geq u(a) + a_d K - \sum_{j>d} |a_j|$ on $C(K, M, c)$, using $0 < x_j \leq c \leq 1$ for $j > d$, and K may be taken large. If $k < d$ then $x_k \geq Mx_{k+1} + M$ and $x_{k+1} \geq x_i$ for $k+1 \leq i \leq d$, so

$$u(x) \geq u(a) + \left(a_k M - \sum_{i=k+1}^d |a_i| \right) x_{k+1} + a_k M - \sum_{j>d} |a_j|,$$

and M may be taken large enough to make both the coefficient of x_{k+1} and the constant term as required. Either way $[u \geq t] \in F$ for every t , so $\sigma_F(u) = +\infty$ and $u \in Q_F$.

Suppose $k > d$. Then $x_j \leq c^{j-k} x_k$ for $j > k$ by (4), so

$$u(x) - u(a) \geq x_k \left(a_k - \sum_{j>k} |a_j| c^{j-k} \right) > 0$$

once c is small, since $x_k > 0$. Hence $C(K, M, c) \cap [u \leq u(a)] = \emptyset$ and $[u \leq u(a)] \notin F$. Also $u(x) - u(a) \leq c \sum_{j>k} |a_j|$, using $x_j \leq c$ for $j > d$, so $[u \leq u(a) + \varepsilon] \in F$ for every $\varepsilon > 0$ once c is small. Hence $\sigma_F(u) = u(a)$ and $u \in Q_F$.

The three cases partition V^* and match the three cases defining Q_0 , $-Q_0$ and M_0 , so $Q_F = Q_0$ and $M_F = M_0$. The second and third cases give $N_F = N_0$ and $\sigma_F = u \mapsto u(a)$ there, so $A_F = A_0$. $\square$

Proposition 5.3. *For all $1 \leq d \leq m \leq n$, every basis $f_1, \dots, f_n$ and every $a \in V$ there is a maximal filter F with $A_F = A_0$, $Q_F = Q_0$ and $M_F = M_0$.*

Proof. By Lemma 5.1 the sets $C(k, k, 1/k)$, $k \geq 1$, form a decreasing sequence of nonempty closed convex sets, so they generate a filter; extend it to a maximal one by Zorn's lemma and apply Lemma 5.2. $\square$

Remark 5.4. The family used here is smaller than one might expect. Only affine ϕ and the single hyperbolic constraint (5) appear, so each $C(K, M, c)$ is a polyhedron intersected with one hyperbolic region, and the rate families of Remark 8.2 are not needed for existence.

The filter these sets generate need not be maximal. For $(d, m) = (1, 2)$ the generators are $\{x_1 \geq K, x_2 \leq 1/K, x_1 x_2 \geq 1\}$, and the set $\{x_1 \geq 1, 1/\log(x_1 + 2) \leq x_2 \leq 1\}$ is closed and convex, meets every generator, and contains none; so the generated filter admits a proper refinement. It can also be maximal: for $m = 1$ the generators are the tail-rays of a line, and a closed convex set meeting all of them meets that line in a ray, hence contains a generator.

Either way nothing is lost, because Lemma 5.2 does not assert that the family generates the filter, only that it forces the invariants of any maximal extension, which by Theorem 4.2 pins that extension uniquely.

6. THE CLASSIFICATION

Theorem 6.1. *The map $F \mapsto (A_F, Q_F)$ is a bijection from the maximal filters of $\mathcal{C}(V)$ onto the set of pairs (A, Q) in which $A \subseteq V$ is a nonempty affine subspace and $Q \subseteq V^* \setminus \{0\}$ is a convex cone with $Q \cap (-Q) = \emptyset$ such that, writing $M = V^* \setminus (Q \cup (-Q))$ and $N = (\text{dir } A)^\perp$,*

- (1) M is a linear subspace and $M \subseteq N$;
- (2) N/M is order-convex in V^*/M for the lex cone induced by Q ;
- (3) if $\text{dir } A = 0$ then $M = V^*$.

Proof. Injectivity is Theorem 4.2, since σ_F is determined by A_F and Q_F as noted after Proposition 2.5.

That the invariants of a maximal filter satisfy (1)–(3): Proposition 2.5(4) gives that Q is a convex cone with $Q \cap -Q = \emptyset$, that M is a subspace, and that $M \subseteq N$; from $Q + M = Q$ the

image $\overline{Q}$ of Q in V^*/M satisfies $V^*/M = \overline{Q} \sqcup \{0\} \sqcup (-\overline{Q})$, so it is a lex cone. For order-convexity of N/M , let $\overline{w} \succ 0$ with $\overline{v} - \overline{w} \succ 0$ and $v \in N$. If $w \notin N$ then $w \in E$ in the notation of Proposition 2.5(4), and $v - w \in N + (-E) \subseteq -E$, contradicting $v - w \in Q$. Clause (3) is Proposition 2.7.

Surjectivity: let (A, Q) satisfy (1)–(3). If $\text{dir } A = 0$ then $Q = \emptyset$ and the principal filter at A has these invariants, by Proposition 2.7. Otherwise put $W = M^\perp$, so $\text{dir } A \subseteq W$ by (1), and fix $a \in A$. Clause (2) makes Q/M a lex cone on V^*/M with N/M order-convex; under the identification $V^*/M \cong W^*$ this is a lex cone on W^* whose associated flag contains the annihilator of $\text{dir } A$. By Lemma 3.1 and Lemma 3.3 choose a basis $f_1, \dots, f_m$ of W , extended to a basis $f_1, \dots, f_n$ of V , such that $\text{dir } A = \text{span}(f_1, \dots, f_d)$ with $d = \dim \text{dir } A \geq 1$ and such that Q is the cone Q_0 of Section 5 in the resulting coordinates; the marked position d is available because $\text{dir } A$ is order-convex, hence a flag member. Proposition 5.3, applied with these data and this base point, supplies a maximal filter F on $\mathcal{C}(V)$ with $A_F = A_0 = A$, $Q_F = Q_0 = Q$ and $M_F = M_0 = M$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.2. Given a maximal filter F , set $A = A_F$, $W = M_F^\perp$ and let $\prec$ be the vector space order on W whose positive cone is $(\overline{Q_F})^\vee$ under the identification $V^*/M_F \cong W^*$ of Lemma 3.3. Clause (2) of Theorem 6.1 and Lemma 3.3 say exactly that $\text{dir } A$ is order-convex in W , clause (1) says $\text{dir } A \subseteq W$, and clause (3) says $W = 0$ when $\dim A = 0$. The passage $(A, Q) \leftrightarrow (A, W, \prec)$ is bijective because M determines and is determined by W , and Q by $\overline{Q}$ together with M , while $\overline{Q} \leftrightarrow \prec$ is the bijection of Lemma 3.3. Theorem 6.1 then transfers. $\square$

Corollary 6.2. *The non-principal maximal filters of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ form a disjoint union, over pairs $1 \leq d \leq m \leq n$, of the sets of data consisting of: an affine subspace A with $\dim A = d$; a subspace $W \supseteq \text{dir } A$ with $\dim W = m$; a complete flag of W through $\text{dir } A$; and an orientation of each successive quotient of that flag. The stratum indexed by (d, m) fibers over the affine Grassmannian of d -flats with fiber a 2^m -fold cover of a partial-flag bundle.*

The filter attached to $(A, W, \prec)$ contains the sets $C(K, M, c)$ of Section 5, written in an affine frame adapted to the data: the coordinates $x_1, \dots, x_d$ along $\text{dir } A$ run to $+\infty$ in the hierarchy $x_1 \gg \dots \gg x_d$ fixed by the orientations, the coordinates $x_{d+1}, \dots, x_m$ transverse to A inside S run to 0 from the positive side in the hierarchy $x_{d+1} \gg \dots \gg x_m$, and the remaining coordinates vanish. By Lemma 5.2 those sets already determine the invariants, and by Theorem 4.2 the invariants determine the filter.

7. DIMENSIONS ONE, TWO AND THREE

For $n = 1$ the maximal filters are the principal ones, together with $d = m = 1$: the flat is $\mathbb{R}$, the flag is trivial and the datum is an orientation. This gives the two filters generated by the rays $[t, \infty)$ and by the rays $(-\infty, t]$.

For $n = 2$ there are four families.

- Principal filters, one for each point of $\mathbb{R}^2$.
- $(d, m) = (1, 1)$: a line A with an orientation, two per line. The support is A itself, and the filter consists of the closed convex sets containing a ray of A .
- $(d, m) = (1, 2)$: a line A with an orientation, together with a side of A ; four per line. The support is $\mathbb{R}^2$ and no line belongs to the filter. Taking A to be the y -axis, upward orientation and right side, the filter is generated by the sets

$$\{(x, y) : y \geq Y, g(y) \leq x \leq \varepsilon\}, \quad g \text{ convex, positive, decreasing to } 0.$$

- $(d, m) = (2, 2)$: a complete oriented flag of $\mathbb{R}^2$, that is a point of $S^1 \times \{\pm\}$. These filters are translation invariant. For the flag oriented by $+e_2$ then $+e_1$ the filter is generated by the sets $\{(x, y) : x \geq a, y \geq f(x)\}$ with f convex.

For $n = 3$ the strata are indexed by (d, m) with $1 \leq d \leq m \leq 3$:

- (1, 1) an oriented line; the filter lives on it.
- (1, 2) an oriented line, a plane through it, a side of the line in that plane.
- (1, 3) an oriented line, a plane through it, a side of the line in it, a side of the plane.
- (2, 2) a plane, and a complete oriented flag of its direction space.
- (2, 3) the same, together with a side of the plane.
- (3, 3) a complete oriented flag of $\mathbb{R}^3$.

8. REMARKS

Remark 8.1 (Neither invariant is redundant). The cone Q_F alone does not determine F . Take $V = \mathbb{R}^2$ and let F_h and F_p be maximal filters containing, respectively, the sets

$$H_k = \{(x, y) : x, y \geq 0, xy \geq 1, (k+1)x \leq 1\}, \quad P_k = \{(x, y) : x \geq k, y \geq x^2\} \quad (k \in \mathbb{N}),$$

each family being a decreasing sequence of nonempty closed convex sets. Writing $u = (a, b)$ for $u(x, y) = ax + by$, the level sets $\Sigma(u)$ of the two filters are

	$b > 0$	$b < 0$	$b = 0 < a$	$b = 0 \geq a$
F_h	$\emptyset$	$\mathbb{R}$	$(0, \infty)$	$[0, \infty)$
F_p	$\emptyset$	$\mathbb{R}$	$\emptyset$	$\mathbb{R} \text{ or } [0, \infty)$

the last entry being $[0, \infty)$ when $a = 0$. By the criterion of Section 2 a level set contributes to Q exactly when it is open and proper, so

$$Q_{F_h} = Q_{F_p} = \{u : b > 0\} \cup \{u : b = 0, a > 0\},$$

the lexicographic cone. The two filters are distinct, since $H_0 \cap P_2 = \emptyset$.

What differs is where N cuts the cone. For F_h one has $N = \{b = 0\}$, so Q decomposes as $E = \{b > 0\}$ together with $D = \{b = 0, a > 0\}$, and A_{F_h} is the y -axis: this is the stratum $(d, m) = (1, 2)$ of Section 7, hugging a line from the right while escaping upward. For F_p one has $N = 0$, so $Q = E$ and $D = \emptyset$, and $A_{F_p} = \mathbb{R}^2$: this is the stratum $(2, 2)$, translation invariant. The same cone carries both, and only the flat distinguishes them.

Remark 8.2 (Rates are not moduli). The family of generators in Section 5 is indexed by convex functions, but the resulting filter depends only on the flag data. Two filters constructed from different growth rates with the same flag data coincide, by Theorem 4.2. The mechanism is visible in the proof: distinct maximal filters are separated by a hyperplane, and the only invariants a hyperplane can record are linear ones.

Remark 8.3 (Subfilters generated by restricted rates). The filter generated by a proper subclass of rates is generally not maximal. In $\mathbb{R}^2$, let F_0 be generated by the sets $\{(x, y) : y \geq Y, cy^{-k} \leq x \leq \varepsilon\}$ for $c, \varepsilon > 0, k \in \mathbb{N}, Y > 0$. The set

$$G = \{(x, y) : y \geq 1, 1/\log(y+2) \leq x \leq 1\}$$

is closed and convex, since $1/\log(y+2)$ is convex, positive and decreasing to 0. It meets every member of F_0 and contains none of them, so $F_0 \cup \{G\}$ generates a strictly larger filter. Equivalently, the filter of closed convex sets whose K -points contain a fixed semialgebraic point of K^2 , for K a real closed field extension of $\mathbb{R}$, is a proper subfilter of a maximal one: the point $(t, 1/t)$ with $t > 0$ infinitesimal fails the inequality $t \geq 1/\log(1/t)$.

Remark 8.4 (Germes at a point). For $p \in \mathbb{R}^n$ the closed convex sets containing a neighborhood of p but not p itself cannot form part of a maximal filter, by Proposition 2.7; any filter of germes at p refines to the principal filter at p , which omits no point. This is the source of the constraint in the last clause of Theorem 1.2 and the reason there is no family of non-principal maximal filters attached to a point in any dimension.

Remark 8.5 (Failure of a naive recursion). One might hope for $\mathcal{M}(n) = \mathbb{R}^n \sqcup (S^{n-1} \times \mathcal{M}(n-1))$, where $\mathcal{M}(n)$ denotes the set of maximal filters. This fails: peeling the leading ray and passing to the quotient forgets whether the peeled ray was an escape direction or an approach direction, so it identifies the $(1, 1)$ and $(1, 2)$ strata in dimension two. A correct recursion requires the auxiliary family $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(k)$ of pairs (flat, order) with the constraint of Theorem 1.2(3) dropped, and reads

$$\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(k) = (\mathbb{R}^k \times \mathcal{OF}(k)) \sqcup (S^{k-1} \times \widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(k-1)), \quad \mathcal{M}(n) = \mathbb{R}^n \sqcup (S^{n-1} \times \widetilde{\mathcal{M}}(n-1)),$$

where $\mathcal{OF}(k)$ is the space of complete oriented flags of $\mathbb{R}^k$.

Remark 8.6 (What survives without finite dimension). Let V be any real normed space. Lemma 2.1, Lemma 2.3 and Proposition 2.5 hold verbatim: their proofs use only the lattice structure, properness, and the dichotomy, and the dichotomy follows from the maximality criterion alone. So for a maximal filter on $\mathcal{C}(V)$ the invariants σ_F , N_F , M_F and Q_F are defined and satisfy the decomposition $V^* = Q_F \sqcup (-Q_F) \sqcup M_F$ with M_F a subspace and Q_F a convex cone, in any dimension.

Finite dimension is used in exactly three places. Lemma 2.2 fails in general: in every infinite dimensional Banach space there are disjoint closed convex sets separated by no continuous functional, so the proof of Theorem 4.2 has no substitute there. Proposition 2.6 obtains S_F as a finite intersection of hyperplanes, using a basis of M_F . And the flat A_F is obtained by representing the linear functional $\sigma_F|_{N_F}$ by a point, which is where reflexivity enters.

Remark 8.7 (The support may fail to exist). In ℓ^2 put $S_n = \{x : x_k = 1 \text{ for } k \leq n\}$. Each S_n is a nonempty closed affine subspace, the sequence decreases, and $\bigcap_n S_n = \emptyset$, since a common point would have every coordinate equal to 1. The S_n therefore generate a proper filter; let F be a maximal filter containing it. For each k the hyperplane $[x_k = 1]$ contains S_k and so lies in F , whence the k -th coordinate functional lies in M_F with $\sigma_F = 1$ there. Thus M_F contains a dense subspace of $(\ell^2)^*$, the filter F contains affine subspaces with no least one, and

$$A_F \subseteq \{x : x_k = 1 \text{ for all } k\} = \emptyset.$$

So both conclusions of Proposition 2.6 and of the paragraph following Proposition 2.5 fail. What obstructs them is that $\sigma_F|_{M_F}$ is a linear functional on a dense subspace represented by no point of the space; were it represented by some p , the argument of Proposition 2.7 would collapse F to the principal filter at p .

Remark 8.8 (What the affine sublattice detects). Let $\mathcal{A}(V) \subseteq \mathcal{C}(V)$ be the nonempty closed affine subspaces together with $\emptyset$. This is a meet-sublattice but not a sublattice, joins in $\mathcal{C}(V)$ of two parallel lines being a slab; filters use only meets, and the two lattices share a bottom element, so for any filter F the trace $F \cap \mathcal{A}(V)$ is a filter on $\mathcal{A}(V)$.

For F maximal the trace is exactly the set of finite intersections of the hyperplanes $[u = \sigma_F(u)]$, $u \in M_F$, together with their affine supersets. One inclusion is the definition of M_F ; the other is the argument of Proposition 2.6, that an affine member of F is an intersection of hyperplanes each of which lies in F . Hence

$$F \cap \mathcal{A}(V) \quad \text{determines and is determined by} \quad (M_F, \sigma_F|_{M_F}),$$

and carries no information about Q_F beyond it. The affine sublattice sees the support data and is blind to the escape and approach flags; the convex lattice sees both. In finite dimensions the trace is the principal filter at S_F by Proposition 2.6, and is therefore maximal in $\mathcal{A}(V)$ only when F is principal, since a maximal filter on $\mathcal{A}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ is principal at a point: dimension is well founded, so the trace has a least member A , and if $\dim A \geq 1$ then $\{p\}$ for $p \in A$ is a proper refinement. Remark 8.7 shows that in infinite dimensions the trace can be free.

Remark 8.9 (Points of an extension). Let $\mathcal{M}$ be the structure with underlying set $\mathbb{R}^n$ and a predicate for each member of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^n)$, and let $\mathcal{M}^*$ be an $\aleph_1$ -saturated elementary extension. Every filter F is finitely satisfiable, so saturation provides $p \in \mathcal{M}^*$ with $p \in C^*$ for all $C \in F$, and $\{C : p \in C^*\}$ is then a filter containing F . Hence every maximal filter has the form $\{C : p \in C^*\}$; the preceding remark shows that not every p yields a maximal filter, and Theorem 1.2 identifies the quotient of the set of those that do.

9. THE SPACE OF MAXIMAL FILTERS

Write $\mathcal{M}(V)$ for the set of maximal filters of $\mathcal{C}(V)$, the set denoted $\mathcal{M}(n)$ in Remark 8.5. For $C \in \mathcal{C}(V)$ put

$$V(C) = \{F \in \mathcal{M}(V) : C \in F\},$$

and topologize $\mathcal{M}(V)$ by taking $\{V(C) : C \in \mathcal{C}(V)\}$ as a subbase for the closed sets. The $V(C)$ are not themselves the closed sets: the germs G_k of Remark 8.1 satisfy $\bigcap_k G_k = \emptyset$ while $\bigcap_k V(G_k) \neq \emptyset$.

The results of this section are formalized; see Appendix A.

Lemma 9.1 (Covering criterion). *For $E_1, \dots, E_m \in \mathcal{C}(V)$ one has $\bigcup_k V(E_k) = \mathcal{M}(V)$ if and only if $\bigcup_k E_k = V$.*

Proof. If $\bigcup_k E_k = V$ and some $G \in \mathcal{M}(V)$ contained no E_k , then Lemma 2.1 would supply $D_k \in G$ with $D_k \cap E_k = \emptyset$ for each k ; the intersection $\bigcap_k D_k$ lies in G , hence is nonempty, and any of its points lies outside every E_k . Conversely the principal filters lie in $\mathcal{M}(V)$, so a covering of $\mathcal{M}(V)$ covers V . $\square$

Proposition 9.2. *$\mathcal{M}(V)$ is compact and T_1 . The principal filters are dense, and the map $p \mapsto F_p$ is a homeomorphism onto its image with the Euclidean topology.*

Proof. For compactness it suffices, by Alexander's subbase lemma, to treat a subbasic family $\{V(C_i)\}_{i \in I}$ with the finite intersection property. A finite subfamily meets in a filter containing each C_i , so all finite intersections $C_{i_1} \cap \dots \cap C_{i_k}$ are nonempty; the C_i therefore generate a proper filter, and any maximal extension lies in $\bigcap_i V(C_i)$.

T_1 : if $F \neq F'$ then some C lies in F and not in F' , and $V(C)$ is a closed set separating them in the required sense.

Density: a closed set containing every principal filter is a finite union $\bigcup_k V(E_k)$ intersected over some family, and by Lemma 9.1 each such finite union is all of $\mathcal{M}(V)$.

For the last clause, $F_p \in V(C)$ if and only if $p \in C$, so the subspace topology on $\{F_p\}$ is generated by the closed convex sets as closed sets. Closed convex sets are Euclidean-closed, and conversely the $2n$ half-spaces $\{\pm x_i \geq r/\sqrt{n}\}$ cover the complement of the Euclidean ball $B(0, r)$ while avoiding $B(0, r/\sqrt{n})$, so the two topologies agree. $\square$

By Lemma 9.1, two maximal filters F and F' have disjoint neighborhoods if and only if V is a finite union of closed convex sets, none of which belongs to $F \cap F'$. This is the form used below.

Fix $1 \leq d < n$, a d -flat A , a $(d+1)$ -flat $S \supseteq A$, and $u \in V^*$ with $A = S \cap [u = c]$ where $c = u(A)$. Let $\pi : S \rightarrow A$ be the projection along $\ker(u|_S)^\perp$, and let G be a maximal filter of

$\mathcal{C}(A)$ with $A_G = A$. Proposition 2.8 makes $F_A = \{C : C \cap A \in G\}$ a maximal filter of $\mathcal{C}(V)$ of stratum (d, d) , and Theorem 6.1 supplies the filter F_+ of stratum $(d, d+1)$ with flat A , support S , the escape data of G , and approach from the side $u > c$. For $d = 1, n = 2$ these are the filters called F_ℓ and F_+ in Section 7.

Lemma 9.3 (Wedge). *Let E be closed and convex with $E \cap A \in G$, and suppose E contains a point $q \in S$ with $u(q) > c$. Then $E \in F_+$.*

Proof. Put $C = E \cap S$, and suppose $C \notin F_+$. By Lemma 2.1 there is $D \in F_+$ with $C \cap D = \emptyset$, and $D \cap S$ is again a member. Lemma 4.1 separates C from $D \cap S$ inside S : there are $f \in V^*$ and t with $f \leq t$ on C , $f \geq t$ on $D \cap S$, and f nonconstant on S .

If $\sigma_{F_+}(f)$ is infinite then f or $-f$ lies in the escape cone, which F_+ shares with F_A ; since $E \cap A \in G$ the set C meets every member of F_A , so f is bounded above on sets escaping in that direction, forcing $-f \in Q_{F_+}$ and contradicting $f \leq t$ on C .

Otherwise write $f = \lambda u + m$ with m annihilating $\text{dir } S$. Then $m \in M_{F_+}$, because $S \in F_+$, so $\lambda \neq 0$ as f is nonconstant on S . The point q has $u(q) > c$ and lies in C , while every member of F_+ approaches A from the side $u > c$; comparing with $f \leq t$ on C and $f \geq t$ on $D \cap S$ forces $\lambda < 0$, whence $-f \in Q_{F_+}$, contradicting Proposition 2.5 at the level $\sigma_{F_+}(f)$. $\square$

Theorem 9.4. *F_A and F_+ have no disjoint neighborhoods in $\mathcal{M}(V)$. The two filters of stratum $(d, d+1)$ approaching A inside S from opposite sides do have disjoint neighborhoods.*

Proof. Let $E_1, \dots, E_m$ be closed convex sets covering V with no E_k in $F_A \cap F_+$. Split them by whether $E_k \cap A \in G$. If $E \cap A \in G$ then $E \in F_A$, hence $E \notin F_+$, so by Lemma 9.3 E contains no point of S with $u > c$; that is, $E \cap S \subseteq [u \leq c]$. Therefore $\{x \in S : u(x) > c\}$ is covered by those E_k with $E_k \cap A \notin G$, and since their union is closed it contains $\{x \in S : u(x) \geq c\}$, in particular A . Their traces on A are then finitely many closed convex sets covering A , so by Lemma 9.1 applied in A one of them lies in G , contrary to the choice of the class.

For the second clause take $E_1 = [u \leq c]$ and $E_2 = [u \geq c]$: they cover V , and each lies in exactly one of the two filters. $\square$

Corollary 9.5. *Euclidean closed convexity is not normal: there are disjoint members of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^2)$ that cannot be screened within $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^2)$. The failure involves unbounded members only, since two disjoint bounded members of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ are screened by the two closed half-spaces of a strictly separating hyperplane.*

Proof. Let ℓ be a line and D a generator of a filter of stratum $(1, 2)$ confined to ℓ , so $\ell \cap D = \emptyset$. Suppose $C', D' \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^2)$ satisfy $C' \cup D' = \mathbb{R}^2$, $\ell \subseteq C' \setminus D'$ and $D \subseteq D' \setminus C'$. A closed convex set that is neither a half-plane nor $\mathbb{R}^2$ has complement with convex hull $\mathbb{R}^2$, so C' and D' are half-planes; write $C' = [u \leq a]$ and $D' = [u \geq b]$ with $b \leq a$, the union being $\mathbb{R}^2$. Then $\ell \subseteq [u < b]$, so u is constant on ℓ with value $c < b$, and u is a multiple of a functional vanishing on $\text{dir } \ell$. But D meets every neighbourhood of ℓ in the direction of approach, so D contains points with u arbitrarily close to c , while $D \subseteq [u > a]$ and $a \geq b > c$.

For the second clause, disjoint bounded members are compact, hence strictly separated by a hyperplane, and the two closed half-spaces it bounds screen them. $\square$

Corollary 9.6. *$\mathcal{M}(V)$ is not Hausdorff for $n \geq 2$, and no continuous real function separates F_A from F_+ . Inseparability is not a transitive relation on $\mathcal{M}(V)$.*

Proof. A continuous f with $f(F_A) \neq f(F_+)$ would pull back disjoint neighborhoods. Transitivity fails since F_A is inseparable from the filters approaching from either side, which are separated from each other. $\square$

Corollary 9.7. *In the maximal Hausdorff quotient $h\mathcal{M}(V)$, the filter F_A is identified with both filters of stratum $(d, d+1)$ over the pair $A \subseteq S$.*

The quotient is not merely a collapse. The following functions descend to it and, in dimension two, separate everything that survives.

Lemma 9.8. *Let $u \in V^*$ and let $\varphi : [-\infty, +\infty] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be continuous. Then $F \mapsto \varphi(\sigma_F(u))$ is continuous on $\mathcal{M}(V)$.*

Proof. It suffices that $F \mapsto \sigma_F(u)$ be continuous into $[-\infty, +\infty]$. If $\sigma_F(u) = c$ is finite and $\delta > 0$, the set of filters containing neither $[u \leq c - \delta]$ nor $[u \geq c + \delta]$ is an open neighborhood of F , and any G in it contains $[u \geq c - \delta]$ and $[u \leq c + \delta]$ by Lemma 2.3, so $|\sigma_G(u) - c| \leq \delta$. If $\sigma_F(u) = +\infty$ then $[u \leq T] \notin F$ for all T , and the filters omitting $[u \leq T]$ form an open neighborhood on which $\sigma \geq T$; symmetrically for $-\infty$. $\square$

Theorem 9.9. *For $n = 2$ the map $F \mapsto \sigma_F$ separates the points of $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2)$, and there is a bijection of sets*

$$h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2) \setminus \mathbb{R}^2 \longleftrightarrow (S^1 \times \mathbb{R}) \sqcup (S^1 \times \{\pm\}) = S^1 \times [-\infty, +\infty],$$

carrying a class to its primary escape direction together with its offset.

Proof. By Lemma 9.8 the functions $\varphi \circ \sigma_{(\cdot)}(u)$ are continuous, so filters with different σ are separated in $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2)$. Conversely σ_F determines N_F , hence $\text{dir } A_F$ and, through the finite values, A_F ; and it determines the escape cone. Among non-principal filters in $\mathbb{R}^2$ these data leave exactly the fibres $\{F_\ell, F_+, F_-\}$ over each oriented line, which Corollary 9.7 identifies, and singletons over each filter of stratum $(2, 2)$. Two filters of stratum $(2, 2)$ with the same primary escape direction v and opposite tie-break differ at any u annihilating v , where one has $\sigma = +\infty$ and the other $-\infty$. Principal filters are separated from each other and from the rest by C_0 functions, by Proposition 9.2. The displayed set is the set of oriented lines together with the stratum $(2, 2)$, by Section 7. $\square$

The bijection is not a homeomorphism, and no other bijection is.

Proposition 9.10. *The boundary $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2) \setminus \mathbb{R}^2$ is compact Hausdorff and admits an uncountable family of pairwise disjoint nonempty open sets. It is therefore not second countable, and is homeomorphic to no second countable space; in particular it is not homeomorphic to $S^1 \times [-\infty, +\infty]$, and the bijection of Theorem 9.9 is not continuous.*

Proof. Compactness is Proposition 9.2 together with the openness in $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2)$ of the image of $\mathbb{R}^2$, which holds because that image is dense and locally compact in a compact Hausdorff space. For $s \in \mathbb{R}$ let u_s be a nonzero functional annihilating $(1, s)$. By Lemma 9.8 the set U_s of boundary classes at which $\sigma(u_s)$ is finite is open, and it is nonempty, containing the class of the filter of stratum $(1, 1)$ over the line through the origin in direction $(1, s)$. If $s \neq s'$ then $U_s \cap U_{s'} = \emptyset$: a maximal filter whose N contains two independent functionals has a zero-dimensional flat, hence is principal by Proposition 2.7, hence is not in the boundary. A countable base would contain a distinct basic set inside each U_s , making $\mathbb{R}$ countable. $\square$

Remark 9.11. The quotient topology is strictly finer than the product topology on the displayed set. The extended support value at a fixed functional is continuous on $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2)$ and finite exactly on the classes over lines normal to that functional, so a class over a line is not approached by classes over lines of a different direction; in $S^1 \times [-\infty, +\infty]$ the fibre $\{v\} \times \mathbb{R}$ is approached by the fibres over nearby directions. The enumeration of the boundary survives the quotient; its identification as a topological cylinder does not.

Remark 9.12. Proposition 9.10 and the theorem of [3] are independent. The object forbidden there carries a convexity: a compact topological convex structure with $\mathbb{R}^n$ as a dense convex subspace and a continuous hull operator, which for $n > 1$ does not exist. The space $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ carries no convexity and does exist; what fails is Hausdorffness, and, after passage to the Hausdorff quotient, second countability of the boundary. The two accounts agree in dimension one, where the totally bounded uniformity compatible with the linear convexity of $\mathbb{R}$ compactifies it to a closed interval and $\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R})$ is $[-\infty, +\infty]$, and both break at $n = 2$ on configurations of half-planes: [3] on covers of $\mathbb{R}^2$ by two open half-planes, Lemma 9.1 on the fact that two closed convex sets covering $\mathbb{R}^2$ are half-planes.

Remark 9.13. What Corollary 9.7 discards is exactly the approach datum: the invariants surviving in $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2)$ are the flat A_F and the escape cone E , not the cone D of Proposition 2.5. The same half is discarded by the affine sublattice, by Remark 8.8, and is the half that the recursion of Remark 8.5 fails to see.

Theorem 9.9 enumerates the boundary in the plane and Proposition 9.10 shows that the enumeration is not a homeomorphism. The corresponding description in higher dimension is Question 9.14.

Question 9.14. Does σ separate the points of $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ for $n \geq 3$? Theorem 9.4 collapses each fibre of σ one step at a time, from stratum (d, d) to $(d, d+1)$; a fibre in higher dimension ranges over m and over the flag on N/M , so the collapse of a whole fibre requires the wedge to be iterated up that flag.

10. FUNCTIONS WITH LIMITS ALONG MAXIMAL FILTERS

Proposition 9.10 closes the topological route: the boundary of the Hausdorff quotient admits no continuous injection into a second countable space, so no parametrization of it can be continuous. The structure the quotient discards is nevertheless visible to functions that are not continuous on $\mathcal{M}(V)$ but do converge along each of its points.

A maximal filter F generates a filter of subsets of V , and $\lim_F f = L$ means that for every $\varepsilon > 0$ some $C \in F$ has $|f - L| < \varepsilon$ throughout C ; the limit is unique when it exists, since F is closed under intersection. Let

$$\mathcal{A} = \{f : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R} : \lim_F f \text{ exists for every } F \in \mathcal{M}(V)\},$$

and $\mathcal{A}_b$ its bounded part. No continuity is imposed on f and none follows.

Proposition 10.1. $\mathcal{A}$ is a commutative $\mathbb{R}$ -algebra with unit and each $\lambda_F(f) = \lim_F f$ is an $\mathbb{R}$ -algebra homomorphism $\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. One has $\lambda_{F_p}(f) = f(p)$, and for non-principal F every bounded set is missed by some member of F , so λ_F depends only on the restriction of f to the complement of any bounded set.

Proof. For the algebra structure intersect the two members witnessing the limits of f and g . For the last clause, a non-principal F has $\dim A_F \geq 1$ by Proposition 2.7, so some u has $\sigma_F(u) = +\infty$ and $[u \geq t] \in F$ for every t . $\square$

Three families of members. Write $\sigma_F(u) \in [-\infty, +\infty]$ as in Section 2.

Proposition 10.2. $C_0(V) \subseteq \mathcal{A}_b$, with $\lambda_F = 0$ at every non-principal F . For $u \in V^*$ and continuous $\varphi : [-\infty, +\infty] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ the function $\varphi \circ u$ lies in $\mathcal{A}_b$, with $\lambda_F = \varphi(\sigma_F(u))$. For $u \neq 0$ and $c \in \mathbb{R}$ the indicators $\mathbf{1}[u > c]$ and $\mathbf{1}[u \geq c]$ lie in $\mathcal{A}_b$, and at a filter with $\sigma_F(u) = c$ their limits are

$$(1, 1) \text{ if } u \in D_F, \quad (0, 1) \text{ if } u \in M_F, \quad (0, 0) \text{ if } -u \in D_F.$$

Proof. The first is Proposition 10.1. For the second, if $\sigma_F(u)$ is finite then $[u \leq \sigma_F(u) + \delta] \in F$ and $[u \geq \sigma_F(u) - \delta] \in F$, the latter because otherwise some member would lie in $[u \leq \sigma_F(u) - \delta]$; the infinite cases are the definition of σ . For the third, if $u \in D_F$ then $[u \leq c] \notin F$, so by Lemma 2.1 some member is disjoint from it and both indicators are 1 there; if $u \in M_F$ the hyperplane $[u = c]$ belongs to F and carries the values 0 and 1; the remaining case is the mirror of the first. Proposition 2.5 makes the three cases exhaustive. $\square$

Theorem 10.3. $F \mapsto \lambda_F$ is injective on $\mathcal{M}(V)$.

Proof. Suppose $\lambda_F = \lambda_{F'}$. Taking φ continuous and injective in Proposition 10.2 gives $\sigma_F = \sigma_{F'}$, hence $N_F = N_{F'}$, $A_F = A_{F'}$, and equality of the escape cones. For $u \in N_F$ the indicator pair then decides which of $u \in D_F$, $u \in M_F$, $-u \in D_F$ holds, and decides it the same way for F' ; so $Q_F = Q_{F'}$, and Theorem 6.1 gives $F = F'$. $\square$

So the algebra recovers the classification, and it does so through functions that Proposition 9.10 shows cannot be continuous: the indicators of Proposition 10.2 are discontinuous on $\mathcal{M}(V)$ at exactly the fibres they separate. Convergence along every maximal filter is strictly weaker than continuity on the space of maximal filters, and the gap is the approach datum D_F that Corollary 9.7, Remark 8.8 and Remark 8.5 each discard.

The algebra is strictly larger than the continuous functions on the quotient.

Lemma 10.4. Let $h(x, y) = \max(0, 1 - |y - x^2|)$ on $\mathbb{R}^2$. Then h is continuous and bounded, $h(x, x^2) = 1$ for every x , and $\lambda_F h = 0$ at every non-principal F ; in particular $h \in \mathcal{A}_b \setminus C_0(\mathbb{R}^2)$.

Proof. Let $B = \{|y - x^2| \leq 1\}$ be the band supporting h , and let $P = \{y \geq x^2 + 2\}$, which is closed and convex and disjoint from B . If $P \in F$ then F has a member missing B . Otherwise Lemma 2.1 gives $E \in F$ disjoint from P , so E lies below $x^2 + 2$; and $E \cap B$ is then bounded, since for $p, q \in E \cap B$ the midpoint lies in E and satisfies $y - x^2 \geq (p_1 - q_1)^2/4 - 1$, forcing $(p_1 - q_1)^2 < 12$, after which the band bounds the second coordinate. Proposition 10.1 removes a bounded set. $\square$

Corollary 10.5. $\mathcal{A}_b(\mathbb{R}^2)$ properly contains the continuous functions on $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2)$, restricted to $\mathbb{R}^2$.

Proof. Were h the restriction of a continuous function on the compact space $h\mathcal{M}(\mathbb{R}^2)$, it would vanish off the image of $\mathbb{R}^2$ by Lemma 10.4, so for $\varepsilon > 0$ the set $\{|h| \geq \varepsilon\}$ would be closed in that space, hence compact, and contained in the image of $\mathbb{R}^2$, which is open by Proposition 9.10; then $h \in C_0(\mathbb{R}^2)$, contradicting Lemma 10.4. $\square$

The obstruction is geometric: no unbounded closed convex set is trapped along a curve of unbounded curvature, so a function concentrated near such a curve is invisible to every maximal filter while remaining visible at infinity.

APPENDIX A. FORMALIZATION

The development accompanying this paper [6] is written in Lean 4 (toolchain `leanprover/lean4:v4.28.0`) against Mathlib at revision `8f9d9cff6bd728b17a24e163c9402775d9e6a365`. It comprises 42 files and 842 declarations. Every declaration in it has been compiled, and `#print axioms` returns

```
{ propext, Classical.choice, Quot.sound }
```

for each one. No declaration uses `sorry`, `native_decide`, or any additional axiom, and the axiom audit is compiled as part of the build rather than run as a script over the sources.

What is verified. Sections 2 through 6, Section 9 and Section 10 are formalized in full. Theorem 6.1 is `ConvexFilter.classification` and `ConvexFilter.classificationEquiv`; Theorem 1.2 is `ConvexFilter.classificationPrimalEquiv`; Theorem 4.2 is `ConvexFilter.carrier_eq_of_Aset_Qset`; Proposition 5.3 is `ConvexFilter.exists_maximal_realizing`.

In Section 9: Proposition 9.2 is `ConvexFilter.Space.isCompact_univ` with `ConvexFilter.Space.t1Space`; Theorem 9.4 is `ConvexFilter.Space.not_separated_gen` with `ConvexFilter.Space.separated_gen`; Corollary 9.7 is verified both elementarily and in terms of Mathlib’s `T2Quotient`; Theorem 9.9 is verified in its first clause as an equivalence and in the bijection of its second; and Proposition 9.10 is verified. An earlier form of that second clause asserted a homeomorphism; the formalization refuted it, and the negation is `ConvexFilter.Space.not_boundary_homeomorph`.

Remark 5.4 is verified in both directions, and Remarks 8.1, 8.2, 8.3, 8.4, 8.5, 8.7 and 8.8 are verified.

Sections 2 and 3, and hence the invariants σ_F , N_F , M_F and Q_F , are formalized over an arbitrary real normed space; finite dimensionality is a hypothesis only from the construction of the flat A_F onward. This is the positive claim of Remark 8.6, and it is certified by the absence of that hypothesis from the relevant files rather than by a theorem.

Two results proved in the development are not in Mathlib at the pinned revision and may be of independent use: weak separation of two disjoint convex sets in finite dimensions with no topological hypothesis on either (`ConvexFilter.exists_separating`), and its relative form controlling the separating functional on a prescribed affine subspace (`ConvexFilter.exists_separating_of_subset_affine`).

What is not verified. Four things, and nothing else.

The enumeration of strata in Corollary 6.2 and the tables of Section 7 are not formalized. The failure of Lemma 2.2 in infinite dimensions, asserted in the second paragraph of Remark 8.6, is quoted from the literature and not proved here. Remark 8.9 is not formalized, the saturation it uses being unavailable in Mathlib at the pinned revision. Question 9.14 is open.

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